



COVER STORY: THE STATE OF THE STATES

LEADERS LEAD LAGGARDS LAG 20

The fifth State of the States report reveals that very little has changed in the rankings across five years. Sure there is some movement but it is largely incremental and at the margins.

The Triumphant Trio 34

Best big state, best small state and the best state for investment. Punjab, Puducherry and Gujarat emerge leaders in these categories and set an example before laggards.

Inclusive Inequality 42

India is expected to notch 9-plus per cent growth for the third successive year. But a large section is not on the gravy train, which is the political challenge of the day.

North by North-East 46

Instead of permanent dispensation as special category states, the North-East needs better infrastructure to complement its already strong social fabric

Southern Surge 50

The southern states are way ahead of the others. The North rides high on consumption and the West cashes in on investment, while the North-East is in a state of flux.

Factual State 54

By comparing numbers like inequality levels and literacy rates, the diverse nature of the Indian states gets reinstated yet again

INTERVIEW: BENAZIR BHUTTO

No to Musharraf 66



Bhutto's dreams of returning to Pakistan are laced with uncertainty following Nawaz Sharif's deportation to Saudi Arabia

SMART MONEY: NET BANKING

Bring Home Bank 77



Through Internet, and phones, banks are ready to reach you anywhere, any time. The benefits of home banking are much more than savings in time and money.

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OF THE WEEK



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